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Exploring Resident Experiences of Indirect Displacement
in a Neighbourhood Undergoing Gentrification:
The Case of Saint-Henri in Montréal

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Abstract

The recent proliferation of new-build gentrification has led researchers to emphasize the need to explore the effects of indirect displacement (i.e. the effects of changes caused by neighbourhood gentrification) as experienced by long-term residents (Davidson & Lees 2004). This paper develops a four-tiered indirect displacement typology sub-dividing the concept into: cultural displacement, social displacement, political displacement and housing market displacement. This framework is operationalized in a case study of Saint-Henri, a gentrifying neighbourhood in Montréal (Québec, Canada), to assess whether it is useful in understanding the meanings of displacement in the lives of incumbent residents. The case study reveals that in Saint-Henri, social, cultural and housing market displacement are all relevant to understanding residents' experiences in the face of gentrification and mega-project development. There was not however, evidence of political displacement in Saint-Henri. For example, there were no indications of explicit conflicts between incumbent residents and incoming gentrifiers in trying to shape the future dimensions of place, as has been found elsewhere (see Davidson 2008).

Keywords: gentrification, mega-projects, indirect displacement, neighbourhoods, Saint-Henri, Montréal, Canada

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Résumé

Récemment, l'arrivée de ce qu'on appelle la « new-build gentrification » a conduit les chercheurs à s'interroger sur les effets du déplacement indirect, c'est-à-dire les effets des changements causés par la gentrification dans un quartier, tels qu'ils sont vécus par les résidents de longue date. Cette recherche développe une typologie de déplacement indirect déclinant le concept en quatre types : déplacement culturel, déplacement social, déplacement politique et déplacement relié au marché du logement. Afin de vérifier si ce cadre permet de comprendre les significations du déplacement à partir du vécu des résidents de longue date, il a été mis à l'épreuve par l'étude du cas du quartier Saint-Henri. L'étude révèle que dans ce quartier de Montréal en voie de gentrification, les notions de déplacement social, déplacement culturel et déplacement relié au marché du logement permettent effectivement de comprendre les expériences vécues des anciens résidents face à la gentrification et au développement de mégaprojets. Néanmoins, il n'y pas d'indications de déplacement politique à Saint-Henri; la recherche n'a pu mettre à jour de conflits explicites entre les anciens résidents et les nouveaux arrivants qui essaient de façonner le futur du quartier, comme cela a été constaté ailleurs (voir Davidson 2008).

Mots clés: gentrification, embourgeoisement des quartiers, mégaprojets, quartiers urbains, déplacement indirect, Saint-Henri, Montréal, Canada

In their quest to reimagine and re-appropriate large tracts of urban areas that have been rendered obsolete by deindustrialization, cities are increasingly moving towards mega-projects that combine diverse activities including recreation, culture, shopping and mixed-income housing, based in large part on the idea of adaptive reuse. By 2015, Montréal's McGill University Health Centre mega-hospital will be completed on a former railway yard (Glen Yard), creating demand for housing in adjacent areas as employees seek to live closer to work. This is likely to accelerate gentrification in the adjacent Saint-Henri neighbourhood, where redevelopment of the Lachine Canal—designated a recreational corridor in 1997—has already led both to 'traditional' forms of gentrification (i.e. via renovation of the existing stock) and to substantial new housing development (primarily condominiums). Such a combination of forces acting on a working-class neighbourhood is likely to produce displacement in both direct and indirect forms. Direct displacement refers to instances of eviction of residents due to wider neighbourhood changes, such as gentrification or expropriations for mega-projects. Unlike traditional gentrification, new-build housing on disused land does not directly displace existing residents. It may, however, have indirect (or second order) effects, for instance as the neighbourhood becomes more desirable, rents are likely to increase, or affluent incomers may take over neighbourhood socio-cultural institutions (Davidson and Lees 2004). Research is warranted into such indirect effects on incumbent residents as little is known about lived experiences of social mix in the context of new-build gentrification, where middle-class settlement happens suddenly and in an 'in your face' manner (Rose 2004).

This confluence of forces created optimal circumstances for exploring the different dimensions of indirect displacement in an old-established working-class neighbourhood from the perspectives of affected long-term renters, and adds a Canadian case study to the small body of existing empirical research on indirect displacement. In this paper, after developing an indirect displacement typology that sub-divides second order effects into four constituent types—social, cultural, political and housing market displacement—we present the main findings of a study designed to test this framework empirically in the Saint-Henri context. We explored the meanings of displacement from the perspectives of low and modest-income long-term residents living in rental housing while these wider changes were underway. How do these residents experience displacement? In what ways is it significant to their lives?

1. Gentrification, new-build gentrification and indirect displacement

Traditionally, gentrification involves physical, economic, social and cultural processes, the ‘invasion’ of previously working-class neighbourhoods by middle or upper-income groups and the subsequent direct displacement of many of the original residents (Hamnett 2000). Yet after decades of study, gentrification’s consequences for existing residents remain relatively unexplored and far less well understood than the causes of gentrification, due in part to the difficulty of measuring displacement and in locating displacees (Van Weesep 1994; Slater et al. 2004). Slater (2010) calls for renewed research on displacement ‘from below’ i.e. from the perspective of those experiencing it, arguing that we still have much to learn from moving accounts of ‘love and loss’ in the context of the devastation it causes (Slater 2010).

Gentrification is taking increasingly diverse forms including ‘new-build gentrification’ (either in the form of infill development or the creation of whole new neighbourhoods on brownfield sites). Since such developments create additional rather than rehabilitate existing housing units, developers and municipal governments alike claim that displacement will not occur. Davidson and Lees (2004, 2010) argue, however, that new-build gentrification involves the creation of a gentrified landscape and a concomitant ‘indirect displacement’ of lower-income residents in adjacent communities.

Renewed scholarly interest in the concept of indirect displacement—first articulated as ‘social displacement’ by Chernoff (1980)—is due in part to this proliferation of new-build developments in inner-city neighbourhoods. Two related concepts, ‘displacement pressure’ and ‘exclusionary displacement,’ developed by Marcuse (1986), have also been revived in recent research. For Marcuse, displacement pressure occurs when a household sees the fabric of their neighbourhood change so substantially that they move before they are ‘forced’ out. Atkinson (2000, 321) found indications of this in London, where for many residents, gentrification eroded not only their ability to stay put, but also their desire to do so, as social, physical and economic shifts took place that were: “unrelated to the patterns of their own lifestyles and the resources on which they lived.” Mazer and Rankin (2011) conceptualized the social dislocation of incumbent residents brought on by gentrification in Toronto’s South Parkdale as ‘displacement pressure,’ although in this case the residents remained

in place. What Marcuse called 'exclusionary displacement,' but may be more clearly termed housing market displacement, occurs when a household cannot move into a given dwelling because competition from more affluent households has pushed the cost of housing within the neighbourhood beyond their means. Recent empirical investigations have validated this concept, revealing that as gentrification spreads and intensifies, it precludes the return of former residents from suburban areas (Millard-Ball 2002; Teixeira 2007).

Whereas Chernoff's (1980) original concept of 'social displacement' was very broadly defined, more recent scholarship calls for conceptual refinement. Thus Martin (2007) developed the concept of political displacement, which explores the shifting power dynamics within neighbourhood-based community institutions and organizations and/or the creation of such organizations by incoming residents in gentrifying neighbourhoods (Martin 2007). In the most comprehensive treatment of indirect displacement to date, Davidson (2008) sub-divides the concept into a three-fold classification: 'indirect economic displacement,' which draws upon Marcuse's (1986) exclusionary displacement to further tease out the externalities that gentrifying reinvestment of capital can generate; 'community displacement,' which builds on the research of Chernoff (1980) and Martin (2007) to explore the shifting dynamics of power and how gentrifiers are often central to re-imaginings of place; and last, 'neighbourhood resource displacement,' which considers how incumbent residents experience the reorientation of neighbourhood services to accommodate more affluent incomers. Empirical research in London's Brentford district revealed all three processes underway simultaneously (Davidson 2008). However, we cannot assume that all residents experience the indirect effects of gentrification negatively, since in some circumstances incumbent residents may appreciate improvements in local service provision despite sentiments that such improvements were ultimately not made for them (Doucet 2009; Freeman 2006).

A first step toward refining the concept of indirect displacement is to consider insights from urban sociology on the significance of the neighbourhood for different groups. If the neighbourhood has no particular importance as a social space for incumbent residents, then displacement in direct or indirect forms is presumably of little or no consequence. An international body of literature on social ties and social networks suggests that the neighbourhood is of particular importance for low-income groups and the elderly because their social networks are more neighbourhood-based (Authier 2005; Fortin 1988; Henning and Lieberg 1996; Guest and Wierzbicki 1999). However, it is not clear to what degree these assertions are generalizable. In particular, the claim that low-income people have more locally-rooted networks than higher income groups needs more critical investigation, due to important differences between cases, such as varied cultural contexts and city sizes.

Second, we propose that the concept of indirect displacement be further developed, notably by mobilizing the urban geographical literature on 'sense of place.' As Tuan (1975; 1977) has argued, inasmuch as place can be understood as a type of object, learning to know a neighbourhood requires identification of significant landmarks within that space. Place achieves concrete reality when we are able to experience it with all our senses. Long residence in a particular locale provides us intimate though often

limited knowledge of it. Our concept of place is circumscribed by our daily experiences, thus place includes our street or the shops in the neighbourhood we frequent. Place can thus be seen as a unit of environmental experience, a convergence of thoughts, emotions and behaviours (Canter 1986). Alternatively, Massey (1994) conceptualizes place, not as a coherent static space with a boundary, but rather as constructed by a collection of social relations and networks ranging from local to global.

Discussions around 'sense of place' frequently mobilize two inter-related concepts: place attachment and place identity. Place attachment is often portrayed as a multifaceted concept characterizing the bond between individuals and their important places (Giuliani 2003; Low and Altman 1992). Becoming psychologically attached to place occurs in three main ways, through affect, cognition and behaviour (Scannell and Gifford 2010). Place identity has been described as the incorporation of place into the larger concept of self; a "potpourri of memories, conceptions, interpretations, ideas and related feelings about specific physical settings, as well as types of settings (Proshansky et al. 1983)." As such, the concept of place identity is similar to that of social identity and is used to describe an individual's socialization with the physical world.

The term 'sense of place' is used to emphasize that places are significant because they are infused with meanings and feelings by those who inhabit or experience them (Rose 1995). Location is not enough to create sense of place in itself; it emerges from involvement among people and between people and place (Pretty et al. 2003). In gentrifying neighbourhoods, explorations of 'sense of place' have found often competing representations of place between longstanding residents and incoming gentrifiers (Blomley 2004; Martin 2005). However, more fluid conceptions of place find identities of places constantly in flux and unfixed, formed by the various relationships unfolding within and beyond any particular context of place. As such, "places cannot 'really' be characterized by recourse to some essential, eternalized moment (Massey 1994, 169)."

Thus, in trying to develop a holistic and integrated understanding of displacement we can understand the experience of indirect displacement as losing access or no longer belonging to a neighbourhood; whereas the experience of direct displacement takes away 'home' itself.

Building on this diffuse literature, we further propose a systematic four-fold typology of indirect displacement. First, *social displacement* (defined more narrowly than Chernoff (1980)) explores the social relationships residents have in a particular place and the impact of gentrification upon those ties and networks; a fracturing of these networks might cause feelings of loneliness or grief among residents (Fried 1966). Second, *cultural displacement* refers to competing cultures between gentrifiers, who tend to try to refashion the neighbourhood in their image, and incumbent residents. The neighbourhood thus becomes a site of competing senses of place (Rose 1995; Jess and Massey 1995; Blomley 2004; Martin 2005; Lehman-Frisch 2002, 2008). However, there is a scarcity of empirical accounts of such cultural appropriation by incoming gentrifiers. Cultural displacement can be manifest in changes in urban form, shifts in neighbourhood service provision or changes in neighbourhood use and appropriation. It may be experienced by incumbent residents in a number of ways including economic and cultural exclusion, inconvenience resulting from commercial service displacement, or conversely, appreciation of new local services; it may also affect levels of comfort

in neighbourhood public spaces. Thus our definition of cultural displacement goes beyond Davidson's (2008) 'neighbourhood resource displacement,' so as to explore changes in local neighbourhood services and public spaces, such as parks, related to the influx of more affluent residents, and how such changes are perceived and experienced by incumbent residents. Third, *political displacement*, as defined by Martin (2007), may result in either political disempowerment or, conversely, in political empowerment through access to new social capital. Thus, while similar to Davidson's (2008) concept of 'community displacement,' that of political displacement limits its focus to shifting power dynamics in neighbourhood political apparatuses, and re-imaginings of place put forth through political appropriation (i.e. active mobilization) by incoming gentrifiers. Last, *housing market displacement* occurs when, areas become inaccessible to low and modest income households as competition from higher income groups pushes prices beyond their reach (Marcuse 1986; Millard-Ball 2002). This could mean increased difficulty finding suitable housing, decreased residential mobility, and/or frustration due to living in unsuitable housing. Displacement pressure (Marcuse 1986) may operate as an antecedent to any of these four dimensions of indirect displacement.

2. Methodology

To explore the multiple dimensions of indirect displacement, our case study approach drew on multiple sources. Descriptive analysis of 1996 and 2006 census data permitted assessment of the degree and types of gentrification underway in Saint-Henri. An inventory of commercial service provision on the main neighbourhood commercial street, rue Notre-Dame, was undertaken in 2011 and compared to the situation in 1996, in order to construct an approximate portrait of changes in retail services.

The bulk of the research process, however, consisted of semi-structured interviews with renters living in the neighbourhood for 5 years or more, as this is sufficient time for potential psychological attachment to place to occur (i.e. through daily routines within the neighbourhood), to explore whether they experienced indirect displacement, and if so, what meaning displacement had in their lives. Initially, the sample was limited to private renters as they were thought most susceptible to displacement in various forms. However, it emerged from preliminary analysis that these participants seemed more aptly characterized as 'marginal' gentrifiers, as defined by Rose (1984) to refer to highly educated but precariously-employed professionals with modest or moderate incomes. The sampling frame was thus expanded to include residents of social housing, as neighbourhood community organizers suggested many of the neighbourhood's longer-term low-income residents were living in various forms of housing in the social sector.

The sample consisted of 29 interviews with 34 residents. The majority of interviewees were between 31 and 50 years old, with an over-representation of females. Over two-thirds spoke French as a mother tongue, while a quarter were anglophones, and 3% spoke a non-official language. The majority of interviewees were white.¹ Just under half the sample were private sector renters, while the remainder lived in various types of social rental housing (municipal public housing, coop and non-profit housing). Interviewees came from a range of income levels though the majority were low and modest-income: 50% had a household income of less than \$20 000 and 29% between

\$20 001 and \$39 999. Levels of education varied: 35% had at least some university education, 27% had a college diploma, while the remaining 38% had only high school education. The median length of residence was 39.5 years; 29% of interviewees were recent residents having lived in Saint-Henri for 5-9 years, 50% were longstanding residents having lived there for 10 years or more, and 21% were lifelong residents.

3. The Saint-Henri neighbourhood

Saint-Henri, located in the South-west of Montréal, is one of Canada's oldest working-class neighbourhoods. The opening of the Lachine Canal in 1826 was key to its industrial development (Blais et al. 1981). Abysmal working conditions in neighbourhood factories combined with a long tradition of union activism led Saint-Henri to be a recurring site of labour unrest over many decades (Michaudville 1972).

As a result of deindustrialization, Saint-Henri's population declined continuously from 1966 until 2001 (Statistics Canada 1966 and 2001 Censuses). The hardships of unemployment wrought by deindustrialization and the longstanding tradition of activism laid the groundwork for Saint-Henri as the birthplace of Montréal's first citizens' committees in the early 1960s, eventually leading to the establishment of an array of popular institutions within the neighbourhood (Godbout and Collin 1977; McGraw 1978; Mills 2009). Favreau (1989) categorizes Saint-Henri as a traditional '*quartier populaire*' characterized historically by relative social homogeneity; a sense of neighbourhood belonging developed more on a cultural (i.e. white French-Canadian Catholic) than socio-occupational basis; the creation of a certain type of social and cultural life; and a sense of belonging to a very well-defined neighbourhood, which is central to daily life (Favreau 1989). As early as the late 1980s traditional gentrification began to take hold in parts of the neighbourhood, which Ley (1996, 100) argued would provide the Canadian counterpart to the gentrification of Harlem.

Figure 1: Saint-Henri and its constituent census tracts



More recently, population trends have reversed, with a 9.1% increase between 2001 and 2006 (Statistics Canada, 2006 Census). While Saint-Henri is still a largely working-class and francophone neighbourhood, with a high percentage of single-parent families, low-income households and renters, the widespread conversion of former industrial landscapes into housing, especially new condominium developments along the Lachine Canal, has caused substantial change in recent years. The scale of this conversion has been contested, with community groups in Saint-Henri and adjacent Pointe-Saint-Charles calling for more mixed use development to create more local industrial jobs and limit the spread of gentrification (Germain and Rose 2000; Sénécal and Michel 2002). To this day, the longstanding tradition of activism in the neighbourhood continues unabated. Between 2000 and 2007, there were 72 collective actions in Saint-Henri, many of which protested the condominium developments mushrooming along the Lachine Canal (Hernandez Latorre and Le Bel 2011). One result of this enduring neighbourhood activism is that 27% of the housing stock is in various forms of social and community housing (Ville de Montréal 2009; Statistics Canada 2006).

Between 1996 and 2006, the neighbourhood experienced considerable new-build gentrification, evidenced by increases in population, the number of occupied dwellings, and the almost 500 new owner-occupied dwellings added to the local housing stock (see Table 1). Other classic indicators of gentrification observed include increases in the proportion of highly educated residents, bringing the neighbourhood close to the island average, paralleled by increases in the proportion of professionals and senior managers and a rise in income levels (see Table 1).

Table 1: Key population and housing data for Saint-Henri compared to the Island of Montréal, 1996 & 2006

	1996 – Saint-Henri	1996 – Island of Montréal	2006 – Saint-Henri	2006 – Island of Montréal
Population	13 988	1 775 846	14 802	1 854 442
Occupied dwellings	6420	773 395	7360	831 555
Owner-occupier households	855	264 985	1345	315 420
% owner-occupiers	13.3%	34.3%	18.3%	37.9%
Renter households	5560	508 415	6005	516 130
% renters	86.6%	65.7%	81.6%	62.1%
Average household income (1995 inflation adjusted to 2005 \$) ²	\$31 338	\$49 583	\$39 340	\$57 738
% population aged 15-64 with a university degree	11.2%	18.5%	23.2%	25.8%
% professionals and senior managers in the employed labour force	20.1%	26.2%	25.5%	30.8%

Table 2 reveals a marked decrease in the number of households in the lowest income range (< \$20 000 per year) between 1996 and 2006, possibly suggesting that many of the lowest income residents have been pushed out of the neighbourhood and replaced by households that are better off.³ Alternatively, households formerly in the lowest income range may have moved up to the \$20 000–\$39 999 range. As expected, due to the recent increases in both condominium developments and housing market values more generally, the number of households in the higher income ranges has increased.

Table 2: Distribution of households by income group, 1995 & 2005, (2005 dollars), Saint-Henri

	Less than \$20 000	\$20 000 to \$39 999	\$40 000 to \$79 999	\$80 000 +
1995	3 445	1 555	1 165	230
2005	2 320	2 205	2 055	755
% of total households 1995	53.9%	24.3%	18.2%	3.6%
% of total households 2005	31.6%	30.1%	28.0%	10.3%
% change 1995–2005	–32.7%	+41.8%	+76.4%	+228.3%

However, different census tracts (CT) in the neighbourhood have experienced varying degrees and forms (i.e. traditional vs. new-build) of gentrification (see Figure 1). The northeast sector (CTs 80 and 81), closest to affluent Westmount, has seen the most extensive traditional gentrification (i.e. upgrading of the existing housing stock). Past analyses identified the onset of traditional gentrification in these areas as early as 1981–1991 (Ley 1996; Walks and Maaranen 2008). The areas directly south of this, adjacent to the Lachine Canal (CTs 79 and 83) experienced extensive new-build gentrification—mostly due to the conversion of the former industrial landscape into condominiums, as documented by De Verteuil's (2004) visual analysis of landscapes in the South-West from 1992 to 2002 identifying in this zone a large number of abandoned properties with significant development potential. Likewise, Walks and Maaranen (2008) characterized these areas as exhibiting 'potential for future gentrification' during the 1991–2001 time period. Our analysis confirms that by 2006, there is definitive evidence of new-build gentrification in the areas adjacent to the Canal and Atwater Market, where, between 1996 and 2006, the vast majority of new owner-occupied dwellings were built. The western part of Saint-Henri that abuts the Turcot expressway interchange (CTs 82 and 84) exhibited different patterns of neighbourhood change with less pronounced indicators of gentrification. Again, this is consistent with De Verteuil's (2004) work documenting decline in areas more distant from the dynamic zones proximate to the CBD and Lachine Canal. These areas also had the highest proportions of social and community housing and recent immigrants.

4. Findings: Four constituent types of indirect displacement in Saint-Henri?

Summarizing the evidence from this exploratory study, we now examine whether indirect displacement (as set out in the four-fold typology) is a useful concept for

understanding long-term renters' experiences in Saint-Henri.

Social networks and social displacement?

To examine potential social displacement we explored residents' social networks to see if they had friends and family living locally. All income groups had at least weak ties/acquaintances within the neighbourhood. However, some low-income residents reported having almost all their strong ties in the neighbourhood proving the neighbourhood extremely important to some lifelong residents' social networks:

"For me, Amy, Saint-Henri is Saint-Henri. I have it tattooed on my heart for real, and the people I spend time with, the majority remain in Saint-Henri. I'll tell you that we are a family of seven (...) there are two who have moved. My sister married a soldier so she had to remain close to the military base. And my other sister moved to Ville Saint-Pierre because you can have the same thing as here for \$300 less rent." *[translation] 45 year old woman, lifelong resident, low-income (household income <\$20 000 per year), living in public housing.*

A number of factors led to a fracturing of locally based social networks. First, wide-spread fires within the neighbourhood led to the subsequent displacement of friends who, due to the lack of affordable housing, were unable to find replacement housing nearby. Second, friends or neighbours, pushed out of their homes by repossession-induced-displacement, were unable to find replacement housing close by.⁴ In our study, stories of friends and neighbours whose housing had been repossessed by landlords in 'bad faith' surfaced frequently.⁵ Evidence suggests that even if one has the ability and/or good fortune to remain within the neighbourhood after repossession, such events may have a dire impact on one's social network or social re-integration into the neighbourhood more generally. Third, high turnover in private rental housing (due to lack of maintenance by the landlord) seemed to be a factor militating against 'locally based community' and networks of weak ties, because of the significant energy required to reconnect with neighbours on an annual basis. Tenants perceived the lack of building maintenance as a strategy to ensure turnover, which, accompanied by failure on the part of the landlord to declare past rent on subsequent leases, resulted in larger annual rent increases than technically allowable.⁶ Last, a shift in the familial neighbourhood atmosphere, due to the loss of neighbourhood acquaintances, may, through the dilution of networks of locally-based weak ties, constitute a form of social displacement. Length of residence may be key factor, as the probability of significant neighbourhood turnover (no doubt accelerated by the forces of gentrification) seems more likely to be perceived and experienced negatively by long-term residents.

Cultural displacement in local retail services?

The commercial inventory compared commercial services available on rue Notre-Dame in 2011 to those located at the same address in 1996. Services were divided into five distinctive types⁷ to compare the relative share of each over time (see Table 3).

The greatest proportional gains were in the entrepreneurial businesses category (i.e. services including boutiques, restaurants and cafés, targeted at higher income

groups rather than the incumbent population) and in corporate chains, suggesting a notable incursion of new businesses catering to more affluent residents on the neighbourhood's commercial street. This finding is similar to that of Zukin et al. (2009) on commercial gentrification in Williamsburg and Harlem. While the New York study also observed a sharp decline in local retail businesses (i.e. individually owned small businesses providing commercial services catering to the incumbent population), there were slight increases in the proportion of both local small businesses and community services⁸ on Notre-Dame. This difference could in part be due to the shorter time frame of our comparison compared to the Zukin et al. (2009) study (15 versus 26 years). Alternatively, the sizeable decline observed in the vacancies category might suggest that, to date, entrepreneurial businesses and chain stores were primarily occupying formerly vacant storefronts rather than displacing local small businesses. Over time however, this increased vitality on Notre-Dame could have the effect of raising commercial rents to a point no longer affordable to these small businesses, thus adding to the 'displacement pressure' on the main commercial street.

Table 3: Inventory of available services on rue Notre-Dame 1996 and 2011

Types of businesses/services	1996	2011
Community Services	5.8%	6.2%
Corporate Chains	1.2%	4.7%
Entrepreneurial	0.6%	7.8%
Local	62.8%	64.8%
Unknown	3.5%	3.1%
Vacant	26.2%	13.5%

Despite such evidence that, to date, substantial gentrification-induced commercial displacement has not taken place, interviewee opinions diverged on the subject of neighbourhood retailing. An apparent mismatch between available retail services and the needs of some low-income long-term residents, especially in terms of certain basic items such as children's clothing, forced residents to shop outside of their neighbourhood. Moreover, there was a sentiment among some low-income lifelong residents that recent commercial changes, such as the arrival of boutiques and cafés, were not destined to the incumbent population, but to affluent newcomers:

"Notre-Dame at this point, I find that it is no longer made of stores for the people of Saint-Henri. (...) I go into a little café and go sit down with someone I know, drink a coffee, and it costs \$17 for a coffee and a hot chocolate! (...) Excuse me, but with the salary that I make, raising two children, my rent, my electricity and everything, I cannot afford it. It is no longer boutiques or shops for me. It's like we said earlier, for the

Lachine Canal. (...) It's that the poor have been squeezed out to make room for the rich." *[translation]* 44 year old woman, lifelong resident, low-income (household income <\$20 000/year), living in public housing.

Among some low-income lifelong residents such changes constituted a threat and were perceived as a force pushing low-income residents out of the neighbourhood to make way for higher income residents.⁹ Using Massey's (1994) wider conception of place as constantly in flux due to relationships, networks and interactions both within and beyond the place itself, a more apt description of changes in the retail landscape along rue Notre-Dame might be framed in terms of a dilution of the 'sense of place' held by low-income incumbent residents due to gentrification related changes, rather than displacement per se, with 'displacement pressure' mounting over time.

A shifting 'sense of place' resulting from wider neighbourhood changes was, however, evident in select establishments of the commercial landscape in Saint-Henri. A key site of contestation among residents was the new IGA supermarket—branded with a boutique-style aesthetic distinguishing it from bulk and no-frills stores—which opened in 2006. Some long-term low-income residents lamented the loss of a more familial small-scale neighbourhood grocer, noting their discomfort in the much larger and more expensive store that replaced it:

"It is very, very, very expensive there (...) Here we had a small IGA, and when I say small, it is not just the size of the place, (...) I mean that we felt at home when we went there back in the day. But not today. Today it has moved and been renovated, they built a luxury IGA, (...) it is not even affordable. You no longer feel ... It's no longer our neighbourhood IGA there. It's really no longer the same." *[translation]* 51 year old woman, long-term resident, low-income (household income <\$20 000/year), living in coop housing.

Other more recent modest-income renters (more aptly described as 'marginal gentrifiers'), however, felt that the new IGA was an improvement in the neighbourhood; though not being low-income, they were likely not priced out of the new store to the same degree. Interestingly, a key point of tension was raised by one lifelong low-income resident, who felt conflicted about supporting the new store due to its exorbitant prices yet continued to shop there in order to help sustain the store and protect (in light of deindustrialization and the rise of precarious employment) the jobs of many long-term neighbourhood residents who worked there. The Atwater public market, which also caters at least in part to a higher income clientele, was also a point of discord, evoking equivocal reactions among low-income long-term residents. On the whole, these results suggest that at least for lifelong low-income residents, cultural displacement had occurred only within a few, albeit significant, neighbourhood retail establishments. Increasing displacement pressure is a more apt description of the changes in the neighbourhood commercial landscape overall.

Cultural displacement in neighbourhood public spaces?

Neighbourhood parks were frequented by a variety of renters with and without children

and to a lesser degree the elderly. Dogs arose as an area of conflict in neighbourhood parks. One middle-income renter (a 'marginal' gentrifier) felt a recently built dog run was unsafe for his dog due to the presence of so-called 'aggressive' breeds popular among incumbent residents. Perhaps out of concern for their pets, some owners (including this one) opted to walk their dogs off-leash in other neighbourhood parks, creating in turn, tensions with neighbourhood children and their parents, who did not want to play in areas frequented by dogs:

"They rebuilt Louis Cyr Park (...) but what happened is that they (...) have just put down grass, but then it is like a dog park. (...) When I was little, we went to this park. We would play there. But since 5-10 years, we can't go because there are dogs (...) They leave them off-leashes as well, and do not pick up the poop and leave the dogs roaming free. It's dangerous for children. So we go to the parks further away." [translation] 24 year old female, lifelong resident, high-income (household income >\$80 000/year),¹⁰ living in coop housing.

DeSena's (2012) work in Greenpoint, Brooklyn, revealed that gentrifiers expected accommodation by conveying through their dog-walking behaviour that local laws did not apply to them (e.g. failing to walk dogs on a leash and pick up after them as prescribed by law). In Saint-Henri, similar dog walking practices (including crossing the street to allow dogs to relieve themselves on the 'other' side¹¹) created conflict between new and incumbent residents, adding to the overall displacement pressure for some long-term residents. Interestingly, however, some lifelong and long-term low-income residents felt that the new dog run afforded an opportunity for mixing diverse breeds of dogs and provided some social contact with more affluent newcomers, many of whom owned dogs. This differs from the findings of a study in a large north-eastern U.S. city (Tissot 2011) where gentrifiers who advocated for the creation of a dog run in a gentrifying neighbourhood stressed its contribution in terms of 'connecting people,' despite the fact that users were fairly homogeneous (i.e. middle and upper-income residents).

Lifelong low-income residents had differing perceptions of the redevelopment of the Canal and the changing 'sense of place' along its banks. While some greatly appreciated the improvement in infrastructure along the Canal, others felt it had become too frequented, thus diluting long-term residents' sense of belonging (see also Bélanger 2010). Improvements in neighbourhood parks were widely noted, although greeted with cynicism by some long-term and lifelong residents, who felt insulted that such improvements were made only after the influx of a more affluent population (see Freeman 2006 for an analogous case in Harlem).

Cultural displacement and shifting 'senses of place'

Some interviewees expressed feelings of division and social separation between themselves and incoming condominium dwellers and felt that some new residents were trying to symbolically recast the developments along the Lachine Canal as distinct from the Saint-Henri neighbourhood:

"They are snobs, I'm sorry ... (...) Amy, we were doing a survey on the edge of the canal. People living on the edge of the canal, if you ask them ... "Hello ma'am, you live in St-Henri?" "No, I'm sorry." "Ah, you are in another neighbourhood?" "Well, I live here on the edge of the canal." "Well, madam, the canal is in Saint-Henri." "No, no, no ma'am. I live in..." "Well, tell me the name of your neighbourhood first?" "Well, I live in Montréal!" "I'm sorry to tell you but you live in Saint-Henri." That's what I said to her and then I left. Worse, it was not just a lady, but two ladies who were not together. They do not live in Saint-Henri. They live on the edge of the canal. I'm sorry, but this is where you live." [translation] 45 year old woman, lifelong resident, low-income (household income <\$20 000/year), living in public housing.

Such conflicting and competing 'sense(s) of place' have been found elsewhere (see Blomley 2004), and constitute evidence of cultural displacement. In contrast to Martin (2005), however, we find that in Saint-Henri symbolic representations of place are not only important for affluent newcomers but also for at least some incumbent low-income residents. Feelings of division and social separation were also observed in Doucet's (2009) Leith (Edinburgh-area, Scotland) case study, although in that case they were not perceived as threatening by long-term residents. Like recent findings in Toronto's South Parkdale (Mazer and Rankin 2011), some long-term residents in Saint-Henri were upset by incoming condo dwellers' display of condescension and snobbery. While in Saint-Henri, and to a lesser degree in South Parkdale (see Slater 2004), there was mobilization against the changes wrought by gentrification, in the Leith case there was very little resistance. These two differences between the Doucet (2009) findings and ours may stem from the culture of resistance to gentrification in the neighbourhood. In Saint-Henri, while not all long-term residents experienced this social separation as forcibly negative, those who did were actively engaged in the fight to protect their neighbourhood. This suggests that behaviours such as active engagement in neighbourhood struggles may deepen psychological aspects of place attachment while entrenching place identity (in this case the incorporation of the Saint-Henri neighbourhood into the concept of self).

Political displacement?

To examine potential political displacement, we explored whether incoming gentrifiers had created new organizations that were vying for power with long-established organizations, thereby politically appropriating the neighbourhood. A distinct lack of participation from incoming residents in neighbourhood struggles was noted:

"Well, I think when I go there, what I see a lot of is people like me, who it's been years that they are here. I don't see too many new residents, the rich and all that ... mobilizing for something..." [translation] 32 year old woman, lifelong resident, low-income (household income <\$20 000/year), living in public housing.

This could be temporary, however; as recent research in Berlin revealed, as gentrification

progressed, gentrifiers coopted neighbourhood political movements, shifting the agenda from opposing gentrification and displacement towards 'quality of life initiatives' (Bernt and Holm 2009). In Saint-Henri, a more recent modest-income resident recounted a story of a colleague who visited a condo project posing as a potential buyer, only to discover that one of the main selling pitches by the realtor was:

"What is fun here is that you have the advantage of the canal, but you are backed onto the neighbourhood, so you do not need to be involved", so at the end of the day that is a selling point, "Come here, it's cool, you do not need to invest [socially]." (...) For me it is the major problem that is happening in the neighbourhood (...) people opt for comfort (...) and are fairly indifferent to what is happening outside." *[translation]* 28 year old male, recent resident, modest-income (household income \$20 001-\$39 999/year), living in private rental housing.

These findings complement Bélanger's (2010) research in the same neighbourhood, which revealed that some longstanding residents reproached incoming gentrifiers for their lack of involvement in the social and cultural life of the neighbourhood. However, they contrast starkly with Davidson's (2008) investigation of indirect displacement in three London neighbourhoods, which revealed concrete examples of explicit conflicts between new and existing residents. For instance, one conflict was over plans to redevelop the main commercial street, with evidence of gentrifiers' political weight and power giving them the upper hand in defining the future dimensions of place (Davidson 2008). There was no evidence of this type of conflict underway in Saint-Henri. One reason could be Montréal's much lower position than London in the global hierarchy of advanced tertiary cities, such that the disparity in power between incumbents and incoming gentrifiers (in economic and political terms) would be less extreme. Second perhaps, is a matter of timing, as incoming condo dwellers in Saint-Henri were not actively mobilized in the neighbourhood (i.e. through formation of residents' associations) at the time of fieldwork—a situation that could change as their numbers increase and if the rate of turnover is not too high.¹² We might, therefore, expect displacement pressure due to political appropriation by incoming residents to increase over time.

Housing market displacement?

Although Saint-Henri showed evidence of housing market displacement, it seemed to depend on socio-economic position and was more likely to affect long-term residents:

"It's like in our neighbourhood, we are no longer at home. We cannot come and go as we want. (...) When you're in private rental housing it is not easy, but if you leave the neighbourhood, it is even harder to move back here. So it is like you are no longer at home, no longer able to come and go as you want. It's finished. You no longer have that feeling of belonging, of being at home. Finished." *[translation]* 51 year old woman, long-term resident, low income (household income <\$20 000/year), living in coop housing.

A number of long-term renters, particularly those in neighbourhood public housing, shared this perspective. While they were already priced out of the private rental housing market, their tenure in public housing was secure within the neighbourhood; however their friends and family who had left the neighbourhood and wished to return, had no option but to put their names on public housing lists and hope for the best. This resonates with Teixeira's (2007) finding concerning Toronto's Little Portugal. It was not, however, the perspective of all long-term residents interviewed in this study. One lifelong resident recounted how many of her friends and family had chosen to move to the suburbs due to a confluence of factors including lack of affordable housing, Saint-Henri's reputation as a poor neighbourhood and greater accessibility to green space in suburban areas. Nevertheless, the point remains that whether long-term residents leave voluntarily or not, gentrification foreclosed the option to return.

Some private renters felt the neighbourhood was still affordable; a more recent middle-income resident, needing to facilitate care for his elderly father, had succeeded in finding housing for both his sister and father within a block of where he lived:

"No. It is still within reach. Especially compared to other neighbourhoods, I mean if you compare to the Plateau, I mean, come on, it's the same types of apartments. (...) I had the same type of apartment that I do now and it was like three times what I pay." *35 year old male, recent resident, middle-income (household income \$40 000-\$79 999/year), living in private rental housing.*

Despite his observations elsewhere, this interviewee did not feel at risk from future price inflation, and thus, did not think Saint-Henri was on a trajectory similar to the Plateau Mont-Royal. This resonates with Millard-Ball's (2002) findings in a gentrifying neighbourhood in Stockholm, that as competition for private rental housing increases, it privileges more affluent renters.

Conclusion

In conclusion, we reflect on both the contributions and limitations of this research and suggest future directions for Canadian displacement research. The most substantial contribution of this study is the development of an indirect displacement typology that, by drawing upon a variety of literature from different sub-fields and international traditions within urban studies, refines and nuances this concept by sub-dividing it into four constituent types. Secondly, the operationalization of this framework in fieldwork and qualitative analysis of the interviews helped to identify subtle differences in terms of residents' experiences depending on length of residence, income and type of rental housing tenure. This research reveals that the concept of 'indirect displacement' is useful for understanding resident experiences of the changes associated with gentrification and mega-project development. Overall, we can conclude that there was some evidence of social, cultural and housing market displacement observed in Saint-Henri, particularly among low-income longstanding and lifelong residents. There was no evidence of political displacement underway in the neighbourhood, though this should be re-examined at a later date, as incoming gentrifiers were not actively

mobilized through residents' associations at the time of fieldwork.

There are three main limitations. First, because this was a single-case study design utilizing primarily qualitative methods, there is no larger claim to generalizability of these findings. Replication of these findings in other neighbourhoods in Montréal and elsewhere undergoing similar sets of socioeconomic, cultural and infrastructure changes would be necessary in order to make broader claims about these results being representative of particular 'geographies of gentrification' (Lees 2000). Second, due to the qualitative nature of this study, no attempt has been made to measure the amount of direct displacement underway or map where displacees are going (Atkinson et al. 2011; Wyly et al. 2010; Wellar and van Hulten 2012). A final caveat relates to sampling constraints: recruitment challenges made the sample less diversified than intended. Almost half of interviewees were recruited through community organizations, some of which organize against gentrification and displacement in the neighbourhood. It is possible that stories recounted here have, in some cases, been influenced by residents' involvement with such organizations.

This study helps us identify a number of avenues in need of more detailed exploration in future displacement research. Further examinations of the diverse contexts and experiences of displacement (in both direct and indirect forms) are needed in other Canadian cities, also using qualitative methods in order to glean in-depth understandings of displacement 'from below,' yet attempting to draw more diversified samples (given the virtual impossibility of complementary statistical documentation given available Canadian data sources compared to those in some other countries (see Van Criekingen 2008; 2009)). Second, there is a need to unearth the 'emotional geographies' (Davidson and Lees 2010) of displacement in neighbourhoods undergoing significant new-build development. Last, in light of the particular, although not unequivocal, evidence of indirect displacement on low-income incumbent residents in Saint-Henri, future research could build upon this work to develop specific planning recommendations to limit its negative effects.

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Notes

¹ This is roughly characteristic of the linguistic balance in the neighbourhood, although immigrants are under-represented.

² In 2006, 17.9% of the population received government transfer payments. However, this represented a diminution of 15.5 percentage points since 2001 (Centre de santé des services sociaux du Sud-Ouest-Verdun (2009) Annex 1.)

³ The Consumer Price Index for metropolitan Montréal was used to do this calculation.

⁴ In Québec, landlords can repossess a dwelling for themselves or an immediate family member. In Montréal, a drastic surge in repossession demands was documented beginning in 2000 with cases overwhelmingly located in traditional working-class neighbourhoods in apartments with below-market rents (RCLALQ 2006; Saillant 2006). Repossessions in 'bad faith' have been widely documented where either the stated family member never moves in, or if so, only for a very brief period, before the dwelling is renovated (or not) and subsequently rented to another tenant at elevated rent levels (Saillant 2006; RCLALQ 2006).

⁵ See previous endnote for a definition of 'repossession in bad faith.'

⁶ In Québec, renters actually have a considerable amount of protection against gentrification-induced displacement, due to the presence of a rental board, the Régie du logement. The Régie performs a variety of functions, among them setting guidelines for annual rent increases. However, it has been widely documented that landlords often fail to declare past rent on subsequent leases and raise rents exorbitantly between tenants. The onus is on the tenant to obtain information on past rent and pursue the issue through the Régie.

⁷ The service type categories were adapted from Zukin et al.'s (2009) research, which gauged the degree of commercial gentrification underway in two New York City neighbourhoods.

⁸ NB: This category was not included in Zukin et al. (2009).

⁹ This contrasts with recent findings in a gentrifying neighbourhood in the north of Edinburgh, where even though long-term low-income residents perceived changes in commercial provision to be for others, they tended to view the changes in more positive terms. In this case, however, retail changes were concentrated in a new-build shopping centre, so long-term residents had retained their traditional shopping district which remains a focal point of the incumbent population (Doucet 2009).

¹⁰ This resident was part of a three-generation female-headed household of lifelong Saint-Henri residents interviewed for the study, which included her grandmother, mother (the breadwinner of the family), and daughter (herself).

¹¹ This was noted by a number of low-income residents living on rue Saint-Ambroise whose southern side has seen a proliferation of condos adjacent to the Lachine Canal.

¹² Due to the equivocal evidence of political displacement in the case of Saint-Henri, I have some reservations about the concept itself. In the context of an oral presentation of this research in Montréal, a long-term community activist from Saint-Henri posed a cogent rhetorical question: If the local working-class had no real power to begin with, notwithstanding the strength of local organizations, isn't the debate about political displacement moot?

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